October 2026

KATE PETROVA

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kpetrova@stanford.edu • https://kateptrv.github.io

EDUCATION

Stanford University 2021–2027
Ph.D. candidate in Psychology (expected)

2016–2020
Bryn Mawr College
B.A. in Psychology with a minor in Neuroscience, *summa cum laude*

HONORS AND AWARDS

Walter G. Gores Award for Excellence in Teaching • Stanford University 2026
The university's highest teaching award

Centennial Teaching Assistant Award • Stanford University 2026
The award recognizes teaching assistants who deserve special recognition for outstanding contributions to teaching

Institute for Research in the Social Sciences Dissertation Fellowship • Stanford University 2025
$11,000 • Supports dissertation research that crosses disciplinary boundaries, and relies upon computational social science methods

Affective Science Graduate Student Fellowship • Stanford University 2024
$5,000 • Supports interdisciplinary research in affective science

Norman H. Anderson Award • Stanford University 2021, 2023
$2,000 • Supports research initiatives and studies for graduate students

European Fellowship • Bryn Mawr College 2020
$5,000 • Highest academic prize awarded annually to one graduating senior with one of 10 highest GPAs

Community Building Honor Roll • Bryn Mawr College 2020
Awarded to students who invest time and energy to create a sense of belonging, inclusiveness and community on campus

Frances Velay Women's Science Research Fellowship 2019
$5,000 • Encourages women's leadership in sciences by providing support for summer research

Summer Science Research Grant • Bryn Mawr College 2018
$5,000 • 10-week summer research stipend

PUBLICATIONS

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

†Kross Wallace, L., **Petrova, K.**, & Gross, J. J. (2026). "My Brain Doesn't Speak That Language": An Interpretative Phenomenological Analysis of Alexithymia in Autistic Women. Journal of Emotion and Psychopathology, 1(3), 64–81. https://doi.org/10.55913/77fg3z82

Petrova, K., †Madibekov, N., Gerstenberg, T., & Gross, J. J. (2026). What You See Is What You Regret. In Proceedings of the 48th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society. https://escholarship.org/uc/item/2rh0g87t

Williams, A. J., Rhodes, C. A., Cleare, S., Borschmann, R., Gross, J. J., **Petrova, K.**, Posada, L., Tench, C. R., Chapman-Nisar, A., Martin, L., Hollis, C., Townsend, E., & Slovak, P. (2026). A Socially Assistive Robot to Support Mental Wellbeing in LGBTQ+ Young People at Risk of Self-Harm: A Randomized Controlled Trial. Nature Medicine, 32(6), 2267–2276. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41591-026-04422-6

Behnke, M., Krzyżaniak, W., Nowak, J., Kupiński, S., Chwiłkowska, P., Jęśko Białek, S., Kłoskowski, M., Maciejewski, P., Szymański, K., Lakens, D., **Petrova, K.**, Jamieson, J. P., & Gross, J. J. (2025). The Competitive Esports Physiological, Affective, and Video Dataset. Scientific Data, 12(1), 56. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-024-04364-z

Petrova, K., Gross, J. J., & Gerstenberg, T. (2025). Learning From "What Might Have Been": A Bayesian Model of Learning From Regret. In Proceedings of the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (pp. 5845–5851). https://escholarship.org/uc/item/3zv3g7xg

Petter, J., Mehta, A., **Petrova, K.**, Kindt, M., Sheppes, G., Haslbeck, J. M. B., & Gross, J. J. (2025). Emotion Regulation, Fast or Slow: A Computational Model of Strategy Choice. Emotion, 25(5), 1273–1292. https://doi.org/10.1037/emo0001471

Salias, C., Gross, J. J., **Petrova, K.**, Forbush, K. T., & Preece, D. A. (2025). Eating Disorder Symptoms and Profiles of Emotion Regulation Strategy Use. Journal of Affective Disorders, 380, 94–103. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2025.03.050

Behnke, M., Lakens, D., **Petrova, K.**, Chwiłkowska, P., Jęśko Białek, S., Kłoskowski, M., Krzyżaniak, W., Maciejewski, P., Kaczmarek, L. D., Szymański, K., Jamieson, J. P., & Gross, J. J. (2024). Applying a Synergistic Mindsets Intervention to an Esports Context. Royal Society Open Science, 11(6), 240691. https://doi.org/10.1098/rsos.240691

Johnston, T. E., **Petrova, K.**, Mehta, A., Gross, J. J., McEvoy, P., & Preece, D. A. (2024). The Role of Emotion Beliefs in Depression, Anxiety, and Stress. Australian Psychologist, 59(4), 367–376. https://doi.org/10.1080/00050067.2023.2290734

Petrova, K., Nevarez, M. D., Waldinger, R. J., & Schulz, M. S. (2024). Emotional Support Across Adulthood: A 60-Year Study of Men's Social Networks. Psychology and Aging, 39(8), 933–945. https://doi.org/10.1037/pag0000843

Petrova, K., †Zielke, J. N., Mehta, A., & Gross, J. J. (2024). Occurrent Beliefs About Emotions Predict Emotion Regulation in Everyday Life. Emotion, 24(4), 992–1002. https://doi.org/10.1037/emo0001317

Preece, D. A., Mehta, A., **Petrova, K.**, Sikka, P., Pemberton, E., & Gross, J. J. (2024). Alexithymia Profiles and Depression, Anxiety, and Stress. Journal of Affective Disorders, 357, 116–125. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2024.02.071

Preece, D. A., **Petrova, K.**, Mehta, A., Sikka, P., & Gross, J. J. (2024). Alexithymia or General Psychological Distress? Discriminant Validity of the Toronto Alexithymia Scale and the Perth Alexithymia Questionnaire. Journal of Affective Disorders, 352, 140–145. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2024.01.271

Petrova, K., & Gross, J. J. (2023). The Future of Emotion Regulation Research: Broadening Our Field of View. Affective Science, 4(4), 609–616. https://doi.org/10.1007/s42761-023-00222-0

Preece, D. A., Mehta, A., **Petrova, K.**, Sikka, P., Bjureberg, J., Becerra, R., & Gross, J. J. (2023). Alexithymia and Emotion Regulation. Journal of Affective Disorders, 324, 232–238. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2022.12.065

Preece, D. A., Mehta, A., **Petrova, K.**, Sikka, P., Bjureberg, J., Chen, W., Becerra, R., Allan, A., Robinson, K., & Gross, J. J. (2023). The Perth Alexithymia Questionnaire-Short Form (PAQ-S): A 6-Item Measure of Alexithymia. Journal of Affective Disorders, 325, 493–501. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2023.01.036

Preece, D. A., **Petrova, K.**, Mehta, A., & Gross, J. J. (2023). The Emotion Regulation Questionnaire-Short Form (ERQ-S): A 6-Item Measure of Cognitive Reappraisal and Expressive Suppression. Journal of Affective Disorders, 340, 855–861. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2023.08.076

Petrova, K., & Schulz, M. S. (2022). Emotional Experiences in Technology-Mediated and In-Person Interactions: An Experience-Sampling Study. Cognition and Emotion, 36(4), 750–757. https://doi.org/10.1080/02699931.2022.2043244

Petrova, K., Nevarez, M. D., Rice, J., Waldinger, R. J., Preacher, K. J., & Schulz, M. S. (2021). Coherence Between Feelings and Heart Rate: Links to Early Adversity and Responses to Stress. Affective Science, 2(1), 1–13. https://doi.org/10.1007/s42761-020-00027-5

Petrova, K., Nevarez, M. D., Waldinger, R. J., Preacher, K. J., & Schulz, M. S. (2021). Self-Distancing and Avoidance Mediate the Links Between Trait Mindfulness and Responses to Emotional Challenges. Mindfulness, 12(4), 947–958. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12671-020-01559-4

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Petrova, K. (in preparation). Computational Affective Science.

Petrova, K., †Costa, A., †Dang, A., †Mallen, S., Yanowitch, N., Gerstenberg, T., & Gross, J. J. (in preparation). Counterfactual Construction in Regret.

Petrova, K., Saad, M., †Dang, A., Geng, G., Yaz, B., Gross, J. J., & Gerstenberg, T. (in preparation). Learning From Regret.

CHAPTERS IN EDITED BOOKS

Petrova, K., & Gross, J. J. (2023). Emotion Regulation in Self and Others. In I. Roskam, J. J. Gross, & M. Mikolajczak (Eds.), Emotion Regulation and Parenting (pp. 35–54). Cambridge University Press. https://doi.org/10.1017/9781009304368.004

† undergraduate mentee

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

CHAIRED SYMPOSIA

Petrova, K. (March 2025). Computational Affective Science. Symposium chaired and organized at the Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Portland, OR.

TALKS

Petrova, K., †Dang, A., Geng, G., Yaz, B., Gross, J. J., & Gerstenberg, T. (June 2026). Regret at First Sight: Counterfactual Attention Predicts Regret in an Eye-Tracking Study. Annual Meeting of the Bay Area Affective Science Society, San Francisco, CA.

Petrova, K., Gross, J. J., & Gerstenberg, T. (June 2025). Affective Science in Silico: A Case Study of Regret. Annual Meeting of the Bay Area Affective Science Society, Stanford, CA.

Petrova, K., Gross, J. J., & Gerstenberg, T. (March 2025). Mind the Information Gap: When Regret Helps or Hurts Learning. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Portland, OR.

Petrova, K., Gross, J. J., & Gerstenberg, T. (June 2024). Learning From Regret: A Computational Affective Science Approach. Annual Meeting of the Bay Area Affective Science Society, Berkeley, CA.

Werner, K. M., **Petrova, K.**, & Gross, J. J. (March 2024). Emotion Regulation Flexibility: A Process Model Framework. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, New Orleans, LA.

†Shainy, M. R., **Petrova, K.**, & Gross, J. J. (February 2024). From Trait to State Emotion Beliefs. Virtual flash talk presented at the Annual Convention of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.

Petrova, K., & Gross, J. J. (March–April 2023). Occurrent Beliefs About Emotions Predict Emotion Regulation in Everyday Life. Flash talk presented at the Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Long Beach, CA.

†Zielke, J. N., **Petrova, K.**, & Gross, J. J. (March–April 2023). Examining the Roles of Emotion Beliefs and Interpersonal Emotion Regulation in Loneliness. Flash talk presented at the Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Long Beach, CA.

Petrova, K., Nevarez, M. D., Rice, J., Waldinger, R. J., Preacher, K. J., & Schulz, M. S. (March–April 2022). Coherence Between Feelings and Heart Rate: Links to Early Adversity and Responses to Stress. Virtual talk presented at the Symposium on Emotion Coherence, Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science.

Petrova, K., & Schulz, M. S. (April 2021). Emotion Recognition in Digitally Mediated Communication. Virtual flash talk presented at the Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science.

POSTERS

†Costa, A., **Petrova, K.**, & Gross, J. J. (March 2026). The Stories We Tell Ourselves: Narrative Closure and the Regulation of Regret. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Pittsburgh, PA.

†Mallen, S., **Petrova, K.**, & Gross, J. J. (March 2026). What's Done or Left Undone: The Behavioral Consequences of Counterfactual Framing in Regret. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Pittsburgh, PA.

Petrova, K., †Dang, A., Geng, G., Yaz, B., Gross, J. J., & Gerstenberg, T. (March 2026). Regret at First Sight: Counterfactual Attention Predicts Regret in an Eye-Tracking Study. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Pittsburgh, PA.

†Kross Wallace, L., **Petrova, K.**, & Gross, J. J. (March 2024). Situational Contributors to State Alexithymia: A Mixed-Methods Approach. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Emotion Regulation Preconference, New Orleans, LA.

Petrova, K., & Gross, J. J. (March 2024). Reappraisal as Reasoning: A Computational Affective Science Approach. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, New Orleans, LA.

Werner, K. M., **Petrova, K.**, Uusberg, A., Uusberg, H., & Gross, J. J. (March 2024). Unpacking the Complexity of Emotion Polyregulation. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Emotion Regulation Preconference, New Orleans, LA.

†Zielke, J. N., **Petrova, K.**, Mehta, A., & Gross, J. J. (March 2024). Examining the Causal Role of Reappraisal on Emotion Beliefs and Affective Wellbeing. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Emotion Regulation Preconference, New Orleans, LA.

Petrova, K., †Shaw, J. S., & Gross, J. J. (February 2023). What Makes Interpersonal Emotion Regulation Work? Examining the Roles of Reappraisal and Validation. Annual Convention of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology, Atlanta, GA.

Petrova, K., & Gross, J. J. (March–April 2022). Solomon's Paradox in Emotion Regulation: Exploring the Self-Other Asymmetry in Reappraisal Effectiveness. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Long Beach, CA.

Preece, D. A., Mehta, A., **Petrova, K.**, Sikka, P., Bjureberg, J., Becerra, R., & Gross, J. J. (March–April 2022). Alexithymia and Emotion Regulation. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Long Beach, CA.

Petrova, K., Nevarez, M. D., Waldinger, R. J., & Schulz, M. S. (February 2021). Variation in the Subjective Experience of Loneliness: Latent Profile Analysis and Links to Wellbeing. Annual Convention of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology, virtual.

Petrova, K., Nevarez, M. D., Rice, J., Waldinger, R. J., Preacher, K. J., & Schulz, M. S. (April 2020). The Origins and Active Ingredients of Regulatory Flexibility. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, virtual.

Tharaud, J. B., **Petrova, K.**, Waldinger, R. J., & Schulz, M. S. (April 2020). In Search of Memories Past: Core Relational Themes and Affective Experiences. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, virtual.

Rice, J., Anderegg, V., **Petrova, K.**, Schulz, M. S., & Waldinger, R. J. (April 2019). Whose Report Matters More? Multiple Perspectives on Parental Relationship Satisfaction and Their Influence on Offspring Relationship Satisfaction Later in Life. Harvard Psychiatry Day, Boston, MA.

Petrova, K., Nevarez, M. D., Waldinger, R. J., Preacher, K. J., & Schulz, M. S. (March 2019). Navigating Common Emotional Challenges: The Roles of Mindfulness and Emotional Engagement. Annual Conference of the Society for Affective Science, Boston, MA.

Rice, J., Anderegg, V., **Petrova, K.**, Schulz, M. S., & Waldinger, R. J. (November 2018). Does My Parents' Marriage Affect My Own? The Impact of Parental Relationship Satisfaction and Stability on Offspring Relationship Satisfaction and Stability Later in Life. Annual Convention of the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies, Washington, DC.

† undergraduate mentee

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

PRIMARY INSTRUCTOR

PSYCH 124: What Makes You Tick? An Introduction to Affective Science
Stanford University • Winter 2025 (53 enrolled), Fall 2025 (84 enrolled)

Psychology Summer Research Seminar
Stanford University • Summer 2024 (16 enrolled), Summer 2026 (20 enrolled)

TEACHING ASSISTANT

PSYCH 205: Foundations of Cognition
Stanford University • Spring 2026 (7 enrolled)

PSYCH 198: Honors Seminar in Psychology
Stanford University • Fall 2024 (15 enrolled), Spring 2025 (15 enrolled)

PSYCH 95: Abnormal Psychology
Stanford University • Spring 2024 (65 enrolled)

PSYCH 80: Personality and Affective Science
Stanford University • Winter 2024 (95 enrolled)

PSYCH 90: Clinical Psychology
Stanford University • Fall 2023 (121 enrolled)

PSYCH 1: Psych One
Stanford University • Fall 2022 (354 enrolled), Spring 2023 (283 enrolled)

PSYC 314: Multivariate Statistics
Bryn Mawr College • Spring 2018 (16 enrolled), Spring 2019 (16 enrolled), Fall 2020 (16 enrolled)

PSYC 105: Introductory Psychology
Bryn Mawr College • Fall 2018 (105 enrolled), Fall 2019 (98 enrolled)

GUEST LECTURER

PSYCH 1: *Emotion*
Stanford University • 7 quarters (2023–2026)

SUPERVISION OF UNDERGRADUATE HONORS THESES

Ana Costa (2026). The Stories We Tell Ourselves: Narrative Closure and the Regulation of Regret.

Susie Mallen (2026). What's Done or Left Undone: The Behavioral Consequences of Counterfactual Framing in Regret.

Jules Jackson (2026). Changes in Primal World Beliefs in Individuals With Major Depressive Disorder During Treatment and Beyond.

Julia Steinberg Shaw (2025). Reappraisal of Daily Experiences of Solitude.

Lucy Kross Wallace (2024). Situational Contributors to State Alexithymia: A Mixed-Methods Approach.

Julia Zielke (2024). Examining the Causal Role of Reappraisal on Emotion Beliefs and Affective Wellbeing.

Sophie Lloyd-Hurwitz (2023). "Emotional Stuckness": An Exploratory Study Into Failures to Initiate Emotion Regulation.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ad Hoc Reviewer 2021–present
Affective Science (4), Emotion (4), Cognition and Emotion (1), Emotion Review (2), Computers in Human Behavior (1), JAMA (1), Nature Scientific Reports (2), Journal of Emotion and Psychopathology (2), Cognitive Behaviour Therapy (1), Psychiatry Psychology and Law (1), Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin (1)

Society for Affective Science Student Committee (SASSC) Member-at-Large 2025–present
Society for Affective Science

Annual Meeting Organizing Committee Member 2024–2025
Bay Area Affective Science Society

Faculty Search Committee Member 2024–2025
Department of Psychology, Stanford University

Graduate Program Committee Student Member 2023–2024
Department of Psychology, Stanford University

Affective Science Seminar Series Co-Organizer 2022–2023
Department of Psychology, Stanford University

October 2026

Conference Submission Reviewer 2020–present
Association for Psychological Science, Society for Personality and Social Psychology, Cognitive Science Society

Psychology Major Representative 2019–2020
Department of Psychology, Bryn Mawr College

Faculty Search Committee Member 2019
Department of Psychology, Bryn Mawr College

DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION

Paths to PhD Speaker • Stanford University 2021–2023
Speaker at the annual Paths to PhD event hosted by the Committee on Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion in the Department of Psychology at Stanford University

Committee Member • Bryn Mawr College 2020–2021
International Students Planning and Programming Committee.

SCIENCE OUTREACH AND COMMUNICATION

Scientific Auditor and Co-Author (Appendix B: "Evaluating the Evidence") • Zaki, J. (2024). Hope for Cynics: The Surprising Science of Human Goodness (pp. 213–224). Grand Central Publishing.

Petrova, K. (October 2023). Mastering the Art of Emotion Regulation: Three Steps to Make You Feel Better. Psychology Today. https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/feel-better/202310/mastering-the-art-of-rethinking

Co-Host • Stanford Psychology Podcast (5 episodes), 2021. https://www.buzzsprout.com/1801436

PROFESSIONAL SOCIETY MEMBERSHIPS

Cognitive Science Society 2025–present

Society for Affective Science 2020–present

Society for Personality and Social Psychology 2021–2023

SKILLS AND SOFTWARE

Data analysis
Hierarchical Bayesian modeling; GLMMs; structural equation modeling; longitudinal and multilevel analysis; reinforcement-learning modeling; eye-tracking data processing and analysis; psychophysiological signal processing and analysis (ECG, HRV); fMRI preprocessing and analysis.

Software and programming
Proficient: R (tidyverse, lme4, brms, lavaan), Python (NumPy, Pandas, PyTorch, scikit-learn, Matplotlib), Mplus, SPSS, Amos, HLM, Git/GitHub
Intermediate: JavaScript (jsPsych), webppl, MATLAB, FSL